



AMERICAN FORK CITY COUNCIL
AUGUST 25, 2026
MEETING MINUTES

Members Present:

Bradley J. Frost	Mayor
Staci Carroll	Council Member
Tim Holley	Council Member
Ryan Hunter	Council Member
Ernie John	Council Member
Clark Taylor	Council Member

Staff Present:

David Bunker	City Administrator
Christina Tuiaki	Executive Assistant
Anna Montoya	Finance Director
Stephanie Finau	Deputy Recorder
Sam Kelly	Public Works Director
Patrick O'Brien	Community Development Director
Derric Rykert	Community Services Director
Aaron Brems	Fire Chief
Cameron Paul	Police Chief
George Schade	IT Director
Heather Schriever	Legal Counsel

Also present: Kevin Barnes, Aaron Booker, Elizabeth Phelon (Phelon Lakeland), Debbie Shaw, Roy Shaw, Dale Stewart, Maria G. Cane, Devin Goodwin, Daniel Sroka, Jan Chamberlain, Joan Hamblin, Mary Mitchell, Elizabeth Oscarson, Andria Tamita, Steve Goodwin, and Gregory Titus.

The American Fork City Council held a regular session on Tuesday, August 25, 2026, in City Hall, located at 31 North Church Street, commencing at 7:00 p.m.

REGULAR SESSION

1. Pledge of Allegiance; Invocation by Council Member Taylor; roll call.
Mayor Frost welcomed everyone to the meeting. Those present recited the Pledge of Allegiance and an invocation was offered by Council Member Taylor.
2. Twenty-minute public comment period - limited to two minutes per person.
Aaron Booker, a nonresident, criticized what he viewed as inconsistent enforcement of meeting decorum and a broader pattern of selective enforcement within the City and Police Department. He urged City officials to apply standards equally, protect First Amendment rights, and pursue meaningful reform.

Roy Shaw, an American Fork resident, requested an independent third-party review of the Police Department's accountability, leadership, and handling of alleged misconduct. He stated that the review should determine whether systemic or leadership failures exist, restore public confidence, and guide any appropriate personnel action. He also expressed concern that similar requests from residents had received no meaningful response.

Debbie Shaw described her family's longstanding service to American Fork and raised concerns about alleged civil-rights violations involving her son and others. She requested a fair, transparent, and independent review of the Police Department and urged City leadership to restore public trust through accountability and action.

Dale Stewart requested that the city halt construction of a large accessory structure at 731 North 900 West until a thorough review and neighborhood notification could occur. Representing eight households in American Fork and Lehi, he raised concerns about the structure's size, impacts on views, sunlight, property values, and quality of life, as well as possible errors in the approval record and setback calculations.

Maria G. Cane, a Lindon resident, expressed appreciation for American Fork and its library. She requested that the library provide receipts for printing payments, explaining that she needs documentation of her expenses for tax and recordkeeping purposes.

Devin Goodwin, a resident, asked the city to consider developing a radio-controlled car park at Art Dye Park, the JC Ballpark, or another City park. He noted that a local Facebook group has more than 1,000 members and that other cities have built or are developing similar facilities.

Daniel Sroka urged the City to take action to restore public trust in the Police Department, suggesting policy revisions, improved body cameras, or a resident review board. Citing public critiques of body-camera footage, Mr. Sroka called for meaningful reform and emphasized the importance of protecting constitutional rights.

Jan Chamberlain, a member of the NO ICE in Utah County Coalition, requested a meeting with City officials to discuss immigration enforcement policies. She supported lawful due process while encouraging a humanitarian approach that protects innocent immigrants and children. She also asked the City to consider policies limiting the use of municipal property and local law-enforcement resources for federal immigration enforcement.

Joan Hamblin requested that the city replace the "Season's Greetings" display on Main Street with a commercial grade "Merry Christmas" sign. She stated that the change would honor American Fork's history and traditions, strengthen community identity, and remain welcoming to people of all beliefs. Ms. Hamblin submitted a petition and offered to help raise funds for the display.

Mary Mitchell an American Fork resident supported an independent review of the Police Department and urged the city to rebuild public trust, particularly among vulnerable and immigrant communities. She requested greater transparency regarding the Police Department's cooperation with ICE under Utah County's 287(g) Agreement, citing concerns about racial profiling and residents becoming afraid to contact law enforcement.

Elizabeth Oscarson, an American Fork resident, opposed ICE activity within the city and stated that residents deserve to feel safe. She requested complete transparency and public reporting regarding interactions between City departments and federal immigration authorities.

Andrea Tamita, a 93-year-old American Fork citizen, urged City officials and residents to address wrongdoing, hold public officials and safety patrols accountable, and protect children.

Steve Goodwin thanked Council Member Hunter for clarifying the location of the future fire station. He also corrected an earlier statement and noted that the American Fork Citizen continues to publish articles about the City Council.

Gregory Titus stated that his and his wife's constitutional rights had been violated in American Fork. He expressed a willingness to work with City officials and invited them to contact him regarding his concerns.

3. City Administrator's Report

Mr. Bunker had nothing to report.

4. Council Reports

Council Member Hunter had nothing to report

Council Member Holley thanked residents who brought community concerns to the Council's attention, specifically acknowledging Mr. Stewart for raising the issue discussed. He noted that Council members cannot be aware of every issue and encouraged residents to continue sharing their observations and concerns during meetings or by email.

Council Member John had nothing to report.

Council Member Carroll had nothing to report.

Council Member Taylor reported that Fox Hollow Golf Course's annual presentation to the cities of American Fork, Lehi, and Pleasant Grove would be held on September 24 at 6:00 p.m. at Fox Hollow. The presentation will review the golf course's activities and developments from the previous year. He also announced that the Fox Hollow City Cup would be held that Friday, with teams representing American Fork, Lehi, and Pleasant Grove, and invited those interested in participating to contact the organizers.

5. Mayor's Report

Mayor Frost had nothing to report.

COMMON CONSENT AGENDA

(*Common Consent* is that class of Council action that requires no further discussion or which is routine in nature. All items on the Common Consent Agenda are adopted by a single motion unless removed from the Common Consent Agenda.)

1. Approval of the July 14, 2026, city council minutes.
2. Approval of the July 28, 2026, city council minutes.

3. Approval of the August 4, 2026, work session minutes.
4. Approval of the August 11, 2026, public hearing minutes.
5. Approval of a Reimbursement Agreement with Bridge Haven for Bridges at Fox Hollow Plat B.
6. Approval of a Reimbursement Agreement with Deborah and Maurice Navarro for 247 East 700 North.
7. Ratification of city payments (July 22, 2026, to August 18, 2026) and approval of purchase requests over \$50,000.

Council Member John moved to approve the common consent agenda as presented. Council Member Taylor seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member John
Seconded:	Council Member Taylor
Yes:	Staci Carroll, Ryan Hunter, Ernie John, Tim Holley, Clark Taylor
No:	

ACTION ITEMS

1. Review and action on a resolution setting the 2026 Tax Rate for Fiscal Year Ending June 30, 2027.

Ms. Montoya summarized that the City Council adopted the fiscal year 2026–2027 interim budget on June 23. The budget included a proposed \$660,000 property-tax increase to partially staff a new fire station. The original proposal would cost the average homeowner approximately \$33 annually, or \$2.78 per month, representing an increase of about 8.5%. Because the increase required a truth-in-taxation process, the city held a public hearing on August 11.

Ms. Montoya reported that, after adopting the interim budget, the City realized approximately \$100,000 in insurance-premium savings. Those savings would allow the Council to reduce the proposed tax increase while maintaining the planned fire-station staffing. The revised increase would cost the average homeowner approximately \$2.40 per month and represent an annual increase of about 7.4%. She noted that the Council could reduce the proposed tax increase further, including in response to concerns raised about economic-development spending. However, any additional reduction would require corresponding amendments to other budget line items to preserve full funding for the planned fire-station staffing. She directed the Council to the suggested motions and emphasized that members could propose additional budget changes.

Council Member Taylor stated that he remained reluctant to support a property-tax increase but recognized that rising costs make it difficult for the City to continue providing essential services, particularly public safety, without additional revenue. He suggested that the city explore changes to its budgeting practices in the future to help address increasing costs. He recalled that, during the City’s 2021 Truth-in-Taxation process, the first since 2008—residents expressed a preference for smaller, more frequent adjustments rather than substantial increases after long intervals. He opposed using the City’s reserves to cover ongoing expenses and indicated that he favored reducing the proposed increase from 8.7% to 5.7%. He noted that the revised increase would cost the

average resident less than \$2 per month and stated that, although he was not comfortable with any increase, he intended to support the reduced proposal.

Council Member John agreed with Council Member Taylor and opposed using reserves to fund ongoing operations. He noted that the City's strong bond rating helps it secure favorable financing terms and potentially save residents millions of dollars. He cautioned that continued use of reserves could jeopardize that rating and create significant long-term costs.

Council Member John supported the reduced tax-increase proposal identified as Operational Amendment B. He commended staff for identifying savings and emphasized the importance of retaining some economic-development funding because those efforts can generate sales-tax revenue and strengthen the City's overall tax base.

Council Member Hunter agreed that the proposed increase was consistent with residents' comments during the 2021 Truth-in-Taxation process favoring smaller, incremental adjustments instead of infrequent, substantial increases. He noted that the current proposal was limited partly because the city had identified other funding and used reserves to cover certain costs. He supported developing a formal strategy for replenishing reserves after they are used, comparing reserves to a household savings account from which money may be withdrawn for an unexpected expense and then repaid. He suggested that future budgets include a repayment schedule, potentially spanning two or three years, so the City could restore funds used for major capital needs such as wells or fire-station construction.

Council Member Hunter opposed using capital reserves for recurring expenditures or routine vehicle purchases but acknowledged that reserves can appropriately cover significant upfront capital costs. He suggested that modest annual adjustments, possibly tied to a defined rate or repayment metric, could help rebuild those reserves. However, he cautioned against treating annual tax increases as automatic or expected and emphasized that any incremental adjustment should be connected to a clear plan for repaying the City's reserves.

Council Member Carroll acknowledged that increasing taxes is difficult even when the need is clear, emphasizing that the Council understands the financial burden on residents and takes such decisions seriously. She explained that staffing the new fire station was a high priority because firefighter salaries are an ongoing operating expense that must be permanently incorporated into the City's budget rather than funded as a one-time capital cost.

Council Member Carroll commended staff for finding a way to cover approximately \$1.6 million in staffing costs while initially requesting only \$660,000 in additional property tax revenue and then identifying an option to reduce the increase further. She stated that providing 24-hour public-safety coverage to that area of the city justified the additional cost, as reduced or intermittent coverage would be inadequate. Although reluctant to raise taxes, Council Member Carroll indicated that she would support the reduced 5.7% increase.

Council Member Holley asked for clarification regarding Option C. He recalled that the earlier discussion focused on delaying certain capital projects, including playground improvements and lease-purchase expenditures, rather than using reserves. He questioned whether Option C had subsequently changed to include reserve funding and acknowledged that he may have missed updated information because he had been unable to meet with staff as planned.

Ms. Montoya clarified that the proposed \$120,000 playground deferral would delay a capital project and would not require the use of reserves. However, because it represents one-time savings, it would not permanently fund the City's ongoing operating expenses, leaving the budget gap to be addressed the following year. She explained that five vehicle leases were also expiring during the current year. Staff did not recommend extending the leases, so purchasing vehicles would require up to approximately \$345,000 from reserves. This expenditure likewise would not resolve the structural operating deficit. She added that the city has approximately two dozen leased vehicles requiring replacement over the next several years, meaning similar funding decisions would arise again in future budgets.

Council Member Taylor explained that the proposal to use reserves likely originated from a suggestion he made after previously stating that he would not support a tax increase. He had asked whether the city could use reserves on a one-time basis to proceed with the fire station and then adjust future budgets to accommodate its ongoing costs. He clarified that it was a preliminary idea that he had raised without fully analyzing its long-term implications.

Council Member Holley reiterated that he would vote against a property-tax increase because residents were already facing substantial increases in their household expenses. He stated that he had proposed several alternatives, although he acknowledged that not all were ideal, and expressed concern that none had been implemented. He also remained dissatisfied with how the purpose and proposed use of the tax increase had been communicated.

Council Member Holley suggested that, if additional funding or reserves were needed, the city could reconsider approximately \$600,000 associated with a proposed reconfiguration of the fitness center's weight area. He cited his own City utility bill, which had risen from approximately \$110 to \$130 per month in less than three years, as an example of the increasing financial burden on residents. He disagreed with the preference for smaller, more frequent tax increases. He argued that less-frequent increases could be financially preferable because residents could retain and potentially invest the money between adjustments. Although he respected the other Council members' positions and acknowledged that his view might differ from theirs, he stated that he could not support the proposed increase in good conscience.

Council Member Hunter explained that he raised the issue of incremental increases because residents had specifically requested that approach during the 2021 Truth-in-Taxation process. He observed that, had the Council implemented increases of even 1.5% annually since then, the cumulative increase would have remained below 6%, and the city might not have needed an increase that year. He disagreed that residents would benefit from retaining and investing the money between less-frequent tax increases. He noted

that residents living paycheck to paycheck generally do not have discretionary income available to invest and may find small, predictable annual adjustments easier to absorb than a larger increase imposed at one time.

Council Member Hunter acknowledged that routine annual increases could cause the Council to become complacent about the burden placed on residents. He emphasized that each adjustment should still receive careful scrutiny and consideration of the sacrifices required from taxpayers. Nevertheless, he believed the preference for smaller incremental increases had been clearly expressed in 2021, particularly by residents experiencing financial hardship who lacked the means to invest any temporary savings.

Council Member Holley responded that a household must have the additional money available to pay any tax increase, regardless of whether it is imposed incrementally or less frequently. He reasoned that, if residents can afford the additional tax, they could otherwise retain or invest that money; if they cannot afford it, they would be unable to pay the increased tax.

Council Member John emphasized that supporting the increase was not an easy decision and expressed appreciation to staff for identifying a reduced option. He noted that he was approaching retirement and had spoken with many residents living on fixed incomes. He said those residents overwhelmingly preferred smaller, more manageable increases rather than waiting several years and then facing a substantial adjustment.

Although some residents had opposed any increase, Council Member John stated that more of the people who contacted him favored avoiding large, infrequent increases. He acknowledged that inflation was also increasing the City's operating costs and concluded that he did not see another practical way to maintain necessary services.

Council Member Carroll moved to adopt Resolution 2026-08-37R determining the tax rate for the 2026 Tax year and letting taxes upon all real and personal property within the American Fork City Utah, increasing the fiscal 2026-2027 General Fund property tax revenue by \$435,000 or 5.7% and setting the tax rate at 0.1475 and amending the fiscal year 2026-2027 budget to decrease Operational Expenditures as discussed in Option B in order to increase the fire department personnel expense by \$225,000. Council Member John seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member Carroll
Seconder:	Council Member John
Yes:	Ryan Hunter, Staci Carroll, Ernie John, Clark Taylor
No:	Tim Holley

2. Review and action on a resolution adopting the fiscal year ending June 30, 2027, city budgets.

Ms. Montoya explained that adoption of the fiscal year 2027 annual budget was contingent upon the property tax increase approved by the Council. She reviewed that the City held its initial budget hearing on June 9, adopted an interim budget on June 23, and conducted the required Truth in Taxation hearing on August 11. The final budget, which establishes authorized revenues and expenditure for the upcoming fiscal year, was

required to be adopted by August 31. She stated that the proposed motion would revise the budget to reflect the adopted property tax rate. The revisions included reducing general insurance premiums by \$100,000 and economic development funding by \$125,000, with the combined \$225,000 reallocated to prior appropriations.

Council Member Hunter moved to approve Resolution No. 2026-08-38R adopting the American Fork City budget for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2026, and ending June 30, 2027, with adjustments as reflected by the adopted property tax rate. Council Member Taylor seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member Hunter
Second:	Council Member Taylor
Yes:	Ernie John, Tim Holley, Clark Taylor, Ryan Hunter, Staci Carroll
No:	

Mayor Frost stated that the budget process, which began in February, would conclude that evening. He emphasized that the budget is one of the Council's most important responsibilities because it establishes priorities and funds services affecting residents. He thanked Ms. Montoya, Mr. Bunker, department heads, and staff, for the many hours devoted to preparing the budget and noted that work on the next budget would begin in approximately five months.

3. Review and action on the CDBG Subrecipient Agreement for American Fork City Culinary Waterline Improvements - CDBG 11 King Street.

Council Member Holley asked whether someone had been selected to perform the work or whether the item was limited to approving the grant. Council Member Carroll added that this was an agreement with the county.

Mr. Kelly explained that the city was currently soliciting a designer. He anticipated completing the design around December or January, after which the project could be advertised for construction bids and a contractor selected.

Council Member Taylor moved to approve the CDBG Subrecipient Agreement for American Fork City culinary waterline improvements – CDBG 11 as presented and authorize the city to sign the attached agreement. Council Member Hunter seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member Taylor
Second:	Council Member Hunter
Yes:	Ryan Hunter, Tim Holley, Clark Taylor, Staci Carroll, Ernie John
No:	

4. Review and action on a pioneering agreement with AFEW1 LLC for system improvements association with the Edgewater and the Yard subdivisions.

Council Member Holley asked whether the proposed changes addressed everyone's concerns, particularly those of the Allred family. Ms. Schriever stated that contract negotiations were with AFEW and that Mr. Kelly can speak regarding any conversations he had with the Allred family.

Council Members Holley and Carroll emphasized that their primary concern was ensuring the family was satisfied with the proposed changes. They asked whether anything had changed from the previously discussed agreement.

Mr. Kelly explained that the agreement was revised to clarify which building permits would trigger a benefited property owner's reimbursement obligation. The family wanted assurance that minor improvements, such as installing solar panels, would not require immediate payment of approximately \$90,000. He stated that the agreement now identifies the types of improvements that would trigger reimbursement.

Ms. Schriever stated that the discussions were worthwhile because the resulting improvements to the master pioneering agreement would benefit affected property owners and help the City administer future reimbursement agreements more effectively.

Council Member Taylor moved to approve the Pioneer Agreement with AFEW1 LLC for system improvements along the Edgewater North and the Yard projects. Council Member John seconded the motion. Voting was as follows: Carroll, Taylor, John, Hunter, Holley

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member Taylor
Second:	Council Member John
Yes:	Staci Carroll, Clark Taylor, Ernie John, Ryan Hunter, Tim Holley
No:	

5. Review and action on approval to move forward with improvements at the American Fork City Cemetery.

Council Member John moved to approve moving forward with the improvements of the American Fork Cemetery proposed creating 800 traditional burial spaces, 320 cremation niches spaces and 400 ossuary cremation spaces. In addition, I am moving to approve the purchase acquisition. Council Member Taylor seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member John
Second:	Council Member Taylor
Yes:	Tim Holley, Staci Carroll, Ryan Hunter, Clark Taylor, Ernie John
No:	

6. Review and action on approval of the real estate exchange agreement with NBFF Property LLC, Harbor View Development LLC, Rammell Prospective LLC, Russgan LLC, NPF Investments LLC and Walking the Wire LLC. for Lake Shore Drive.

Council Member Taylor moved to approve the real estate exchange agreement with NBFF Property LLC, Harbor View Development LLC, Rammel Prospective LLC, Russgan LLC, NPF Investments LLC and Walking with the LLC for Lake Shore Drive. Council Member John seconded the motion. Voting was as follows: Holley, John, Taylor, Hunter, Carroll

Result:	Approved
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Mover:	Council Member Taylor
Second:	Council Member John
Yes:	Tim Holley, Ernie John, Clark Taylor, Ryan Hunter, Staci Carroll
No:	

7. Review and action on a resolution approving the disposition of lost or mislaid property or seized property.

Council Member Holley moved to adopt the resolution authorizing the disposition of lost or mislaid property or seized property. Council Member Carroll seconded the motion. Voting was as follows: Hunter, John, Carroll, Holley Taylor

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member Holley
Second:	Council Member Carroll
Yes:	Ryan Hunter, Ernie John, Staci Carroll, Tim Holley, Clark Taylor
No:	

8. Review and action on a resolution appointing Mayor Frost to the Utah Lake Authority Governing Board.

Council Member Taylor moved to adopt the resolution appointing Mayor Frost to the Utah Lake Authority Governing Board. Council Member John seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member Taylor
Second:	Council Member John
Yes:	Ernie John, Clark Taylor, Ryan Hunter, Tim Holley, Staci Carroll.
No:	

9. Consideration and action on entering into a closed session to discuss (A) the sale, purchase, and/or lease of real property; (B) pending or reasonably imminent litigation; and (C) the professional character or competence of an individual(s) as described in Utah State Code 52-4-204 and 52-4-205.

Council Member Hunter motioned to enter into a closed session at 8:23 p.m. to discuss the sale, purchase and/or lease of real property; pending or reasonably imminent litigation; and the professional character or competence of an individual(s). Council Member John seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member Hunter
Second:	Council Member John
Yes:	Ernie John, Clark Taylor, Ryan Hunter, Tim Holley, Staci Carroll.
No:	

The American Fork City Council met in a closed session at 8:23 p.m. to discuss the sale, purchase and/or lease of real property; pending or reasonably imminent litigation; and the professional character or competence of an individual(s). Those present included Mayor Frost, Council Member Carroll, Council Member Holley, Council Member Hunter,

Council Member John, and Council Member Taylor. Also present included City Administrator David Bunker, Legal Counsel Heather Schriever, and Chief Paul.

The sale, purchase and/or lease of real property and reasonably imminent litigation was discussed. This portion of the closed session was audio recorded as required by law.

The professional character or competence of an individual(s) was then discussed. See attached affidavit.

Council Member John motioned to end the close session at 10:30 p.m. Council Member Taylor seconded the motion. Voting was as follows:

Result:	Approved
Mover:	Council Member John
Second:	Council Member Taylor
Yes:	Ernie John, Clark Taylor, Ryan Hunter, Tim Holley, Staci Carroll.
No:	

10. Adjournment.

Council Member Taylor motioned to adjourn the meeting. Council Member Hunter seconded the motion. Voting was unanimous.

The meeting adjourned at 10:30 p.m.



Stephanie Finau
Deputy Recorder